

POKER NIGHT

PERFECT DEVELOPER SPECIFICATION

Authoritative product, UX, AI, real-time architecture and acceptance brief for the web app, native iOS app and native Android app.

Purpose: Give the developer one source of truth for building Poker Night as a premium operating system for private home poker games — not simply a tournament clock.

Status: All requirements through the approved Break section are approved. New recommendations added after that section are clearly labeled as recommended additions and should not be treated as silently approved product decisions unless the product owner approves them.

Consolidated from the approved product direction and latest demo feedback
10 September 2026

1. Product Vision & Scope

Poker Night manages the complete lifecycle of a private No Limit Texas Hold'em home tournament: group creation, invitations, RSVP, expected headcount, chip preparation, blind structure, seating, check-in, live tournament control, rebuys/re-entry, add-ons, eliminations, table balancing, colour-ups, prize-pool calculation, payouts and group history.

It does not deal cards, track hands or pots, decide winners, or track physical dealer rotation.

Cash games are supported separately with a deliberately simple free/basic experience and advanced Premium functionality.

2. Platforms & Public Tools

Surface	Requirement
Web app	Full responsive product experience.
Native iOS	Required.
Native Android	Required.
Public tools	Blind Structure Generator, Tournament Clock, ICM Calculator, Payout Calculator; no account required; each has its own URL and
TV/presentation	Read-only browser view via link, QR or code. No dedicated Chromecast/AirPlay integration.

Any earlier PWA-only assumption is obsolete. Native iOS and Android are current requirements.

3. Roles, Membership & Permissions

Role	Scope	Capabilities
Admin	Group	Full group/tournament control; multiple admins; owner transfer path.
Tournament Organizer	One tournament	Operational control for assigned tournament; no group-level admin rights.
Registered Group Member	Group	RSVP, chat, polls, notifications, event/live view, permitted history/stats.
New Guest	Single event	Limited live view only until registration/joining.

- Users may belong to multiple groups; navigation must say Groups.
- Group creator automatically becomes Admin/Owner.
- Any member can invite; invitation stays pending until Admin approval.
- Multiple admins supported.
- Admin-level changes should be recorded in an activity log.
- Organizer cannot remove members, delete group, edit group settings, approve membership, manage admins or access other tournaments' private data.

4. Groups & Member Experience

- Signed-in users can create groups.
- Free groups have a member limit; Premium required beyond it. Exact limit TBD/configurable.
- Custom group image is optional at creation; Group Settings can later support it.
- Groups contain chat, polls, events, history, presets and chip sets.
- Home is a personal/customizable dashboard: Upcoming Games, Groups, Group Chat, Next Event, history, basic stats, activity, invitations, RSVP reminders and Tools.
- Keep Upcoming Games and Join Existing Group.
- Specific group chat: compact Ongoing Events and Ongoing Polls area at top, clean message stream, composer.

5. Events, Links, Guests & RSVP

Shareable event link is first-class. Signed-in members open directly; signed-out members sign in and return to the event; unregistered users enter guest flow; QR resolves to the same event; event code remains useful for TV/presentation.

Guest flow: member shares event link/QR/code → guest selects inviter → selects available guest slot → enters name → reserves slot → Admin/Organizer can confirm/check-in.

Guest live view: timer, blinds, ante, next level, players remaining, average stack, seat, prize-pool visibility allowed by privacy rules, announcements.

RSVP: Going, Going +1, Going +2, Going +3, Going +4, Maybe, Can't Come. Going +N = member + N guest slots. Maybe is not confirmed. RSVP changes close one hour before game.

Example event card: ♠️ Friday Poker Night · Friday, 14 August · 20:00 · Campo Grande · Buy-in: 15 · Rebuys until Level 6 · Add-on available · KO Bounty: 5 · Target duration: 3h 30m

6. Headcount & Check-In

Concept	Definition
Confirmed	Raw confirmed RSVP count.
Expected	Organizer planning estimate; +/- stepper, not text.
Locked	Expected number frozen for physical preparation.
Actual checked-in	Physically present and Admin/Organizer-confirmed.

Example: Confirmed 12, Expected 15, lock 15. Late RSVP changes do not silently reshuffle the locked preparation. Start CTA uses actual checked-in count: "Start Tournament — 13 Players."

- Self-serve check-in only after arrival.
- Player → Awaiting confirmation → Admin/Organizer confirms → official checked-in.
- Record who confirmed and when.
- Pending check-in is not official.
- Kiosk may use the same flow.

7. Tournament Setup — Core Settings

Setting	Behavior
Name/date	Editable.
Start time	Centered premium control; +/- 30 minute stepper.
Target duration	3h, 3h30, 4h, 4h30, 5h, 5h30, 6h.
Buy-in	Numeric; no currency sign in primary UI.
Rebuy/re-entry	Single ON/OFF. If ON: until level (default 6), max per player unlimited/number, price defaults to buy-in and is editable.
Add-on	ON/OFF; price if ON; maximum one/player.
KO bounty	OFF by default; separate bounty amount.
Ante	Off / Big Blind Ante / Individual Ante / system recommendation.
Organizer cost	ON/OFF; 0–20% +/- stepper; default 10%; wording "Percentage retained for equipment, drinks & snacks"; private.
Location	Optional; prefer Google Maps/Places if easy; structured venue/address/map.
Table override	Optional advanced control; automatic balancing is default.
Voice announcements	Tournament-level ON/OFF; Admin/Organizer only.

Core vs advanced hierarchy matters. Override table settings, KO bounty and ante must not visually compete equally with primary setup decisions.

8. APPROVED — Tournament Break Settings

Break is a dedicated Tournament Setup setting. It is part of the generated tournament structure and must be included in duration calculations.

Setting	Options
Break	OFF / ON
Number	1 break / 2 breaks
Placement	Preset levels such as after Level 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, plus Custom level.
Duration presets	5, 10, 15, 20 minutes, plus Custom.
Recommended placement	When rebuys/re-entry are enabled, default recommendation is immediately after the end of the rebuy period.
Customization	Organizer can choose another level and duration.

Example: Rebuys until Level 6; Break ON; Break 1 after Level 6; 10 minutes. If two breaks: Break 1 after Level 6 / 10 min; Break 2 after Level 12 / 10 min.

The AI must account for break time in the target duration. Example: target 4h = 3h40 playing + 20 min scheduled breaks. A break is a real scheduled state, not merely a manual pause.

9. Tournament Director Mode

Before: Headcount → Chips → Structure → Seating → Announcements → Start.

During: Timer → Current/Next blinds → Players → Pause → Next Level → Edit Future Structure → Chips/Colour-up → Seating → Announcements → Live Actions.

All game-level controls belong to Admin/assigned Organizer, not regular member preferences.

10. Chip System & Physical Inventory

- Arbitrary chip colours and denominations; no fixed palette.
- Inventory per colour, denomination and quantity.
- AI constrained to owned chips.
- Validate the entire blind schedule, not just starting level.
- Every SB/BB must be physically postable without excessive tiny-chip change.
- SB does not need to equal exactly half BB; 20/50 or 1200/2500 can be valid.
- Plan colour-ups around Level 7/8 and later.
- Example exchange: 20 white → 2 blue.
- Saved chip setup can be a reusable preset; current game is recalculated around current players/duration.
- Edit suggested stack from AI baseline with +/- per colour.
- Mid-event chip changes and colour-ups require validation.
- Completed levels immutable; future levels editable.

Illustrative stack: 20 white + 15 red + 10 blue + 3 green. Count alone cannot validate value until the actual colour/value mapping is supplied.

11. Dynamic Tournament Engine

The engine is dynamic, not a fixed template. Inputs: actual checked-in players, expected headcount, target duration, physical chip inventory, rebuys/re-entry, add-on, ante and tournament settings.

- Aim for a sensible rebuy period, generally around first two hours where applicable.
- Make rebuys sensible near the close of their window.
- Make add-on worthwhile.

- Preserve playable big-blind depth.
- Aim to finish near target duration.
- Starting stack sanity range ~50–100 BB at Level 1, not rigid.
- Solve stack and blinds together.
- Level durations only 10/15/20 minutes.
- Never remove levels; insert/modify future levels.
- Rebuy stack has same total value as starting stack; later rebuys may use higher denominations.
- AI may recommend pace changes but never silently apply them.
- Manual future edits need visible markers and cannot be silently overwritten by Recalculate.

12. Live Timer & Sync

The timer must be horizontal and prominent; supporting information may be vertical.

- Host device is source of truth.
- Host timer runs locally and does not depend on server round trips.
- Network loss does not stop it.
- Host broadcasts state as network allows; clients reconcile on reconnect.
- Show current level, current blinds/ante, next blinds/ante, players remaining, average stack.
- Bold LEVEL N above countdown, matching reference.
- Green/amber/red depth indicator around AVG STACK.
- Soft shot clock/time bank independent of level timer.

13. Speed Up / Slow Down

- Tap Speed Up or Slow Down.
- Open simple confirmation page/modal.
- Explain proposed future-level change.
- Confirm applies it.
- Cancel leaves tournament unchanged.
- Current/completed levels never change.
- Change begins from next level onward.

This is a lightweight confirmation workflow, not a full editor.

14. Live Tournament Actions — Required

These are live operational controls, not hidden settings.

Action	Required workflow
Rebuy/re-entry	Select player → confirm → add correct stack → prize pool update → timestamp.
Add-on	Select eligible player → confirm → add configured chips → prize pool update → timestamp.
Elimination	Select player → confirm → active count decreases → finishing position recorded → seating recommendation if needed → timestamp
Late player	Add eligible player → immediate seat → count update → balance recommendation.
Check-in	Pending arrival → organizer confirms → official checked-in.
Generate seat	Generate/re-randomize table + seat; organizer confirms physical movement.

Action	Required workflow
Table balance	Show recommendation; pause/confirm if physical movement required.
Colour-up	Show exchange → organizer confirms → record.

Every live operational action should create a timestamped Tournament Event / Activity Log record.

15. Adding Players & Table Balancing

During the allowed registration/rebuy/re-entry period, Admin/Organizer may add an eligible player. The player receives a seat immediately. The system recalculates/recommends balance. If physical movement is required, pause first, move players, confirm, then resume.

Examples: 9 = one table; 10 = 5+5; 11 = 6+5; 12 = 6+6. Developer owns the general algorithm; requirement is balanced and sensible.

16. Seating & Final Table

- Initial seating: random, manual, keep guests with inviter, or separate guests.
- System recommends balance; organizer confirms physical moves.
- No graphical table visualization.
- At 9 remaining from multiple tables: pause, randomize final-table seats and initial dealer position, confirm.
- Do not track ongoing dealer movement.

17. Voice Announcements

Current scope is **level-transition announcements only**.

- Tournament setting ON/OFF; Admin/Organizer only.
- Host device provides room audio.
- At 1 minute: “1 minute remaining,” then next-level blinds.
- At level end: audible 5-4-3-2-1, then “Start of level N — blinds X — duration Y minutes.”
- Natural-language TTS.
- Same authoritative state transition as timer; no drift.
- Mute/volume control.
- Optional synced visual cue, off by default.
- No start/rebuy-closed/final-table/winner/dealer announcements in current scope.

18. Prize Pool & AI Payout Options

Gross pool = buy-ins + rebuys/re-entry + add-ons. KO bounty is excluded from the regular prize pool.

Organizer allocation is private: 0–20%, default 10%, wording “Percentage retained for equipment, drinks & snacks.” Net prize pool = gross collected – organizer allocation.

AI generates multiple payout options, not only one. Example options could cover 3, 4 or 5 paid positions. Each option shows position, percentage and calculated amount.

Place	%	Amount
1st	50%	€75
2nd	30%	€45
3rd	20%	€30
Total	100%	€150

Example: Gross €165 → organizer target 10% → clean rounded organizer amount €15 → net €150. Payout rounding must be deterministic and produce practical clean amounts.

Players/guests see Estimated Prize Pool before settlement and Prize Pool after settlement. They do not see organizer %, organizer amount, rebuy/add-on totals, detailed private calculation or personal financial stats. Afterward they see paid positions/podium names without amounts.

19. Cash Games

Any signed-in user can create a basic cash game; no Admin/Organizer role required.

Basic / Free	Advanced / Premium
Basic/fixed blinds	Customization
Players	Multiple tables
Basic seating	Advanced seating/rebalancing
Session timer	Saved presets
Buy-ins/top-ups	Expanded history/stats
Cash-outs	Advanced controls
Basic reconciliation/history	Other advanced features

Premium gating is feature-level, not creation-level. Backend enforcement is mandatory.

20. TV / Presentation

- Read-only browser view via code/link/QR.
- Timer; current blinds/ante; next level; players remaining; average stack.
- Estimated Prize Pool / Prize Pool.
- Announcements.
- Final podium without amounts.
- No table view.
- Group logo/background personalization may be Premium.

21. Social & Chat

- Group chat, polls, notifications.
- Ongoing events and ongoing polls compactly at top.
- Registered members only; guests cannot participate until registration/joining.

Chat demo needs major visual redesign: centered/max-width desktop, clean message bubbles, hierarchy, clean composer, active events/polls area.

22. History & Stats

Group-level history: games played, wins, podium finishes, average finish, knockouts.

Out of scope: ROI/profit, personal financial stats, graphs, streaks, achievements.

23. Privacy & API Enforcement

Private financial information must be excluded from unauthorized API responses, not merely hidden in the client.

Data	Admin/Organizer	Member/Guest
Gross collected	Yes	No

Data	Admin/Organizer	Member/Guest
Organizer %	Yes	No
Organizer amount	Yes	No
Rebuy/add-on totals	Yes	No
Private payout calculation	Yes	No
Estimated prize pool	Yes	Yes
Final prize pool	Yes	Yes
Paid positions	Yes	Yes, no amounts

Critical screens must be tested for screen-reader accessibility, especially where web/canvas rendering can weaken accessibility.

24. Visual Design System

- Center key content and use sensible desktop max-widths.
- Premium cohesive color system.
- Shared design tokens for color, typography, spacing, shadows and radii.
- Rounder corners and intentional depth.
- Modern sans-serif; serif only as deliberate display typography.
- Avoid low-contrast gray.
- Gold is an accent, not every border.
- Touch-friendly live controls.
- No euro symbols in primary app UI.
- Use red vertical-bar brand texture where appropriate.
- One coherent icon family; do not use generic emojis as UI icons.

Redesign targets: live horizontal timer; Admin home; Create Game hierarchy; chat; start-time picker; chip selector; rebuy/add-on; setup hierarchy; AI generation status; live actions; payout screen.

25. AI Responsibilities

AI task	Rule
Tournament generation	Use checked-in players, expected headcount, duration and chip inventory.
Blind/stack optimization	Solve together; validate entire schedule.
Chip recommendations	Owned denominations only; future levels and colour-ups included.
Table balancing	Recommend sensible distribution.
Payouts	Generate multiple options with percentages and amounts.
Pace recommendations	Suggest Speed Up/Slow Down; never auto-apply.
Manual edits	Preserve and visibly mark; never silently overwrite.

26. Data Model / State Concepts

Recommended objects: Group, GroupMembership, GroupInvitation, AdminRole, Tournament, TournamentOrganizerAssignment, RSVP, GuestSlot, CheckIn, TournamentPlayer, TableAssignment, SeatAssignment, ChipSet, ChipDenomination, ChipInventory, BlindLevel, StructureRevision, LiveTournamentState, TournamentEvent/ActivityLog, Rebuy/Re-entry, Add-on, Elimination, ColourUp, PayoutPlan, PayoutOption, OrganizerAllocation, AnnouncementEvent, CashGame, Notification.

Model the tournament as an authoritative state machine. Recommendations are not physical actions; physical movement requires organizer confirmation.

27. End-to-End Example

Planning: 12 confirm; organizer estimates 15 and locks 15.

Setup: Buy-in 15; rebuys ON until Level 6; unlimited; rebuy 15; add-on 10; KO 5; BB Ante; organizer cost 10%; target 3h30; break ON after Level 6 for 10 minutes.

AI: Generates structure from players, duration, break and physical inventory; validates every level and colour-up.

Start: 13 players check in; CTA says Start Tournament — 13 Players.

Late player: Added during allowed window; immediate seat and balance recommendation; physical movement requires pause/confirmation.

Live: Rebuy, add-on, elimination and colour-up are logged with timestamps.

Speed Up: Confirmation; current level untouched; future change begins next level.

Break: Scheduled break state appears in structure and live view; timer becomes BREAK with remaining break time.

Final table: At 9 remaining, pause, randomize seats and initial dealer position, confirm.

Settlement: Gross pool → private organizer allocation → net pool → AI payout options → organizer selects.

28. Permission Matrix

Action	Member	Organizer	Admin
View group	Yes	Yes	Yes
Chat/polls	Yes	Yes	Yes
Create event	Yes	Yes	Yes
RSVP/own guests	Yes	Yes	Yes
Approve membership	No	No	Yes
Edit group settings	No	No	Yes
Manage admins	No	No	Yes
Run assigned tournament	No	Yes	Yes
Run other tournaments	No	No	Yes
Rebuy/add-on ops	No	Yes	Yes
Seating/rebalance assigned game	No	Yes	Yes
Private financials	No	Assigned game	Yes
Delete group	No	No	Yes

29. APPROVED Acceptance Gates

- Native iOS, Android and web targets supported.
- Host timer remains accurate through network loss.
- Clients reconcile to host.
- Speed Up/Slow Down requires confirmation.
- Completed levels never mutate.
- Manual future edits visibly marked and protected from silent recalculation.
- Rebuy/re-entry, add-on, elimination, late player, check-in, seating and colour-up actions accessible live.
- Every operational action timestamped.

- Balancing works with changing counts; physical moves require confirmation.
- Prize-pool calculations correct; private data excluded from unauthorized API responses.
- AI payout generation produces multiple options with percentages and amounts.
- KO bounty separate from regular pool.
- Chip recommendations constrained by inventory and validate full schedule.
- Voice transitions synchronize to authoritative timer state.
- TV mode read-only and privacy-safe.
- Premium restrictions server-enforced.
- Accessibility tested.
- Shared design tokens and premium visual standard.

Break-specific acceptance: OFF means no scheduled break; ON supports 1 or 2 breaks; each break has placement and duration; presets plus custom values; default recommendation after rebuy period; AI includes break time in target duration; live system recognizes break as a scheduled state.

30. RECOMMENDED ADDITIONS — NOT YET APPROVED

The following ideas were proposed after the approved baseline. They are included here so the developer can see them, but they are **not product-approved until explicitly accepted**.

- Undo/correction workflow for mistaken live actions, with corrections logged rather than silently deleting history.
- Explicit pause reasons such as Break, Seating change, Chip/Colour-up, Player issue, Technical issue, Custom.
- Host takeover if host device fails; another authorized Admin/Organizer becomes authoritative.
- Deliberate Transfer Host workflow to avoid two authoritative devices.
- Clear offline/reconnecting/synced status indicators.
- Explicit tournament phases such as Setup, Check-in, Ready, Running, Break, Final Table, Heads-Up, Finished, Settlement.
- Explicit player statuses such as Invited, Checked-in, Active, Eliminated, No-show, Away.
- Detailed rebuy eligibility state: window open/closed, rebuys used/max, player eligibility, re-entry rules.
- Heads-Up state when two players remain.
- Duplicate-player correction/merge and name/seat correction.
- Organizer text announcements to player phones and TV.
- Post-game tournament summary for organizer.
- Simplified post-game player result screen.
- Shareable results card.
- Separate Group Preset from Tournament Instance.
- Tournament structure versioning/snapshots.
- Explainable AI recommendations.
- AI deterministic fallback if generation fails or times out.
- Financial invariants: payouts + organizer allocation reconcile exactly to gross; payout percentages exactly 100%.
- Export/backup of tournament data.

These are recommendations only. Do not silently convert them into requirements.

31. Developer Priorities

Priority	Focus
P0	Authoritative tournament state, timer sync, permissions, setup, chips/structure, live actions, seating, break state, prize-pool privacy.
P1	AI optimization, payouts, voice, balancing, event/guest flow, TV, social.
P2	Premium polish, personalization, advanced cash games, expanded history/stats, refined presets.

Do not polish screens while the underlying tournament state and permission model is unstable. The live state machine is the foundation.

32. Product Decisions That Must Not Drift

- Poker Night is an operating system for home games, not a card-dealing app.
- Native iOS + native Android + web required.
- Users can belong to multiple groups.
- Tournament Organizer is tournament-scoped.
- Guests are event-scoped.
- Confirmed, Expected, Locked and Actual Checked-in are distinct.
- Host is authoritative for live timer.
- Speed Up/Slow Down requires confirmation.
- Rebuy/re-entry is one toggle.
- Organizer percentage is private and never called rake.
- KO bounty is separate from regular prize pool.
- AI recommends; organizer confirms operational/financial changes.
- Completed levels immutable.
- Manual future edits visibly marked.
- No graphical table visualization.
- No dealer-rotation tracking.
- No personal ROI/profit stats.
- No euro symbols in primary app UI.
- Break is configured in Tournament Setup, supports 1 or 2, placement and duration presets/custom, and is included in AI duration planning.